

# Principles of Programming Languages, 2026.01.27

## Important notes

- Total available time: 2h (*multichance* students do not need to solve Exercise 1).
- You may use any written material you need, and write in English or in Italian.
- You cannot use electronic devices during the exam: every phone must be turned off and kept on your table.
- You cannot use library functions not covered in class in your code.
- Each exercise is valued 10 points, +1 bonus.

## Exercise 1, Scheme

Define a for-each construct for lists, with the following syntax:

**(For-each** <variable> **in** <list> **do** <body>)

The construct may be interrupted with a **break** operation; e.g. (**break** #t) will return true.

## Exercise 2, Haskell

1) Consider a classical unranked tree datatype, called **Utree**, i.e. where each node can have an unlimited number of children. Define **Utree**.

2) Consider the monadic map defined in class for binary trees, presented next. Define a monadic map for Utree.

```
mapTreeM :: Monad m => (t -> m a) -> Tree t -> m (Tree a)
```

```
mapTreeM _ Empty = do return Empty
```

```
mapTreeM f (Leaf a) = do b <- f a
```

```
    return (Leaf b)
```

```
mapTreeM f (Branch lhs rhs) = do lhs' <- mapTreeM f lhs
```

```
    rhs' <- mapTreeM f rhs
```

```
    return (Branch lhs' rhs')
```

3) Consider the State monad seen in class; the following code is used to add a distinct value to all the leaves:

```
numberTree tree = runStateM (mapTreeM number tree) 1
```

```
    where number v = do cur <- getState
```

```
        putState (cur+1)
```

```
        return (v,cur)
```

Define a variant of numberTree for Utree.

## Exercise 3, Erlang

Create a program that takes a single input value X and a list of different "strategy" functions [s<sub>1</sub>, s<sub>2</sub>, ..., s<sub>n</sub>].

Each strategy tries to find a solution for X (e.g., different algorithms to find a prime factor, or different search heuristics). The program takes also a *timeout* value in ms.

The program should:

- Run all strategies in parallel.
- Return the result of the first strategy that finishes successfully.
- Terminate (kill) all the other processes as soon as the first result is found to save resources.
- Terminate all the process if the timeout expires, returning the atom **timeout**.

To kill a process, use the function **exit(P, kill)**, where P is the *Pid* of the process to be killed.

## Solutions

### Ex 1

```
(define *exit-store* '())
(define (break v)
  ((car *exit-store*) v))

(define-syntax For-each
  (syntax-rules (in do)
    ((_ var in L
      do body ...)
      (let ((out (call/cc
                    (lambda (k)
                      (set! *exit-store*
                            (cons k *exit-store*))
                      (for-each (lambda (var)
                                body ...)
                                L))))))
        (set! *exit-store* (cdr *exit-store*))
        out))))
```

### Ex 2

```
1)
data Utree a = Val a | Utree [Utree a] deriving (Show, Eq)

2)
mapUtreeM :: Monad m => (a -> m b) -> Utree a -> m (Utree b)
mapUtreeM f (Val a) = do b <- f a
                        return (Val b)
mapUtreeM f (Utree ts) = do
  ts' <- mp ts
  return (Utree ts')
  where
    mp [] = return []
    mp (t:ts) = do
      t' <- mapUtreeM f t
      ts' <- mp ts
      return (t' : ts')

3)
numberUtree tree = runStateM (mapUtreeM number tree) 1
  where number v = do cur <- getState
                      putState (cur+1)
                      return (v,cur)
```

### Ex 3

```
find_fastest(Input, Strategies, Timeout) ->
  Parent = self(),
  Pids = [spawn(fun() -> Parent ! S(Input) end) || S <- Strategies],
  receive
    Result ->
      cleanup(Pids),
      Result
  after
    Timeout ->
      cleanup(Pids),
      timeout
  end.

cleanup(Pids) -> [exit(Pid, kill) || Pid <- Pids].
```